

Case Study: Partner with research teams to influence strategic direction, turn research and data into actionable insights, and measure design impacts post launch.

Title

Partner with our business and CMI (Customer Marketing Integration) research teams to influence strategic direction, turn research and data into actionable insights, and measure design impacts post launch for our mobile plans.

Description

Verizon refreshes its mobile plans several times a year, looking to increase revenue, attract new prospects, and differentiate its services. For the initial work, we aligned with the value prop business team and research team (CMI) to understand how customers perceived our current mobile plans and what could we do to reduce friction and increase clarity. For the second part of the work, we were focused on (ideally) what would customers want in a plan that is not out there today.

Role

Lead experience architect

Scope

Current mobile plans and future direction for next version of mobile plans.

Impact

Addressed some of the friction points with current plans, and created direction for future plan development, in terms of what customers want but aren't getting served by any telecoms currently.

Context

Address current friction points in our mobile plans today. Identify opportunities for future direction of mobile plans as a competitor distinction. (This was a 10-12 month effort, with two plan releases).

Artifacts

Wireframes and visuals from the work.

Understand and increase clarity:

Study from CMI. Maybe a nice verbatim?

Deck slide showing translation of research into objectives.

Wireframe showing transformation. Testing?

Post release research

Construct a new kind of plan:

Approach

How the work came together.

Working with our research team, we identified friction points in the current mobile plans around understanding. We turned those into re-designs of current plan that addressed the friction points, which we then spot tested with a small group of users, and iterated on the design. Working with the business, we had to then incorporate new features into our design, and research findings. Lastly, research retested the plans with customers.

For the second phase of the project, we did a broader study with research and value teams to both understand what was important to customers that they were not seeing in the market. This was directed by conjoint research in previous years?

Key Decisions

Where the design point of view mattered most.

Simplicity is more powerful than adding more stuff

Often the approach with our products is that **more is better** - with every subsequent release, we try to pack more into our premium plans, with the idea that this increases value. From a design perspective, we knew that the more features we added, the more we increased the cognitive load and complexity. Research backed that up and made it easier to sell that a more minimal,

streamlined experience would be better for the customer. And it also made it obvious that we were not “speaking the customer’s language”.

Basing products on what customers actually want is less risky

Our product cadence can be a constant cycle of conflicts - we need a new thing, that will increase revenue, but also don’t change things too much, because we don’t want to alienate customers, and need to get to market quickly.

As a result, we often move quickly based on hunches (not research) and don’t substantially change our offerings, or process. If we wanted to truly create a product that customers really wanted, and also would distinguish us in the market - we needed to be bold. We were able to get the OK to start 6-8 months before the release (typically it was 1-3 mos max). We were able to test our hunches and research deeply customer’s unmet needs. Additionally, we were able to create multiple prototypes and verify how to best design that experience.

Outcomes

What changed as a result.

- We saw a better understanding from customers, which was reflected in better conversion and premium mix rates.
- Through uncovering our customers' deep needs and friction points, we came up with the direction for a new value proposition for plans that differentiated Verizon in the market.
- Link to other case study?